全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 5 單元 | 日常生活作息 · Daily Life & Routines

Diary of a Weekend Without Mom

媽媽不在家的週末日記

Saturday, March 14. Mom left for a three-day conference in Kaohsiung this morning, and Dad announced that my brother and I would be in charge of the housework. I laughed at first. How hard could it be? By noon, I had stopped laughing. The kitchen was a mess, the laundry basket was overflowing, and my brother had dozed off on the sofa with a bag of chips on his chest.

We made an arrangement: he would wipe the table and polish the floor while I ran errands. The errands sounded easy, but the queue at the post office was so long that I spent forty minutes standing behind a man who wanted to mail eleven packages. Then I had to buy shampoo, tissues, and detergent at the drugstore, where I discovered that I did not know which brand Mom normally buys.

Sunday, March 15. I was awake before seven, which never happens on a weekend. Hanging the laundry turned out to be the most relaxing chore of all; the morning sun felt refreshing, and the neighbors' rooster kept me company. In the afternoon, Dad mowed the tiny lawn in front of our building, and I tried to sew a button back onto my school uniform. It took three attempts and one bleeding finger. After a short nap, we began the preparation for dinner. We had never realized how much hassle a simple meal involves: washing, chopping, cooking, and then washing again.

Monday, March 16. Mom is home. She looked at the clean kitchen and smiled, but then she opened the fridge and asked why there were four bottles of soy sauce. I am becoming accustomed to the everyday work she does without a word, and I think I finally understand why she goes to bed so early. Bedtime for me tonight: nine o'clock.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
housework	*n.*	家事	We share the housework equally in my family. 我們家的家事是平均分擔的。

mess	*n.*	混亂；一團糟	Your room is a mess! Put your clothes away. 你的房間一團亂！把衣服收好。
laundry	*n.*	待洗或洗好的衣物	I do the laundry every Sunday morning. 我每個星期天早上洗衣服。
errand	*n.*	差事；跑腿	Mom asked me to run an errand to the post office. 媽媽要我跑一趟郵局辦事。
queue	*n.*	隊伍	There was a long queue outside the new bubble tea shop. 新開的珍奶店外排了一條長長的隊伍。
chore	*n.*	家庭雜務	Washing the dishes is my least favorite chore. 洗碗是我最不喜歡的家事。
nap	*n.*	小睡；午睡	Grandpa takes a nap after lunch every day. 爺爺每天午餐後都會小睡一下。
hassle	*n.*	麻煩；困擾	Changing trains with heavy bags is such a hassle. 提著重行李換車真是麻煩。
accustomed	*adj.*	習慣的	She is accustomed to getting up at five. 她習慣五點起床。
everyday	*adj.*	日常的	Cooking and cleaning are part of everyday life. 煮飯和打掃是日常生活的一部分。

片語 Phrases

in charge of	負責	Ms. Wang is in charge of the school library. 王老師負責學校圖書館。
doze off	打瞌睡	I dozed off during the long speech. 我在冗長的演講中打起瞌睡來。
turn out to be	結果是；原來是	The stranger turned out to be my mother's old friend. 那位陌生人原來是我媽媽的老朋友。

文法與句型 Grammar

By＋過去時間, S＋had＋p.p.

「到了（過去某時間）時，已經…」。by 後接過去的時間點，主要子句用過去完成式表示在那之前已完成的動作。

By noon, I had stopped laughing.

到了中午，我已經笑不出來了。

V-ing＋...＋V (動名詞當主詞)

動名詞片語當主詞時，視為單數，動詞要用單數形。

Hanging the laundry turned out to be the most relaxing chore.

晾衣服結果成了最放鬆的家事。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。